TASK 3: STEERING, SUSPENSION AND AXLE INSPECTION

Heavy Vehicle Service and Maintenance Technician Level 3 | Block 3 | v1.1

TIME
90 minutes (adapt to workplace conditions)

EVIDENCE
Practical | Knowledge | Documentation

PROGRAMME POINT
Weeks 27-42 | Months 7-11

Your task

Inspect steering, mechanical/air suspension, axle and hub components on a heavy vehicle. Measure selected wear or end float, diagnose the likely cause of abnormal tyre wear and recommend action.

What you must do

1. Confirm reported symptoms, vehicle configuration and inspection limits.
2. Secure and support the vehicle; depressurise or restrain suspension where required.
3. Inspect steering linkages, suspension, axle, hubs and mountings.
4. Measure selected clearances, end float or geometry and compare with data.
5. Record defects, root-cause reasoning and repair/verification recommendations.

What good evidence looks like

SAFE CONTROL
Use approved chassis stands and suspension controls; never rely on air pressure, a jack or self-levelling suspension for support.

CORRECT METHOD
A logical sequence using current manufacturer, DVSA, company and task-specific information.

ACCURATE EVIDENCE
Actual values, test conditions, units, findings and evidence references recorded clearly.

SOUND DECISIONS
A justified serviceability, repair, referral or recovery decision followed by appropriate verification.

You will need

- Heavy vehicle or chassis rig
- Dial gauge, alignment and wear-check tools
- Rated lifting/support equipment
- Manufacturer/DVSA data and PPE

SOW ALIGNMENT

Block 3 - Chassis, Steering, Suspension, Wheels, Tyres and Trailers

KSB evidence focus: K2, S7, S8; reinforced K1, K3-K6, K10, S1, S3-S10, B2-B3

Task reference: HV_L3_Block_3_Task_3_Steering_Suspension_and_Axle_Inspection

Apprentice, location and vehicle details

Apprentice name

Date

Employer / training centre

Vehicle / trailer make and model

Registration / fleet number

Odometer / hours

VIN / chassis / trailer number

Job card / task reference

Measurements and technical checks

Hub end float measured		Hub end-float limit	
Steering free play		Steering specification	
Ride height / pressure		Suspension specification	
Tyre wear / geometry		Diagnosis / action	

Special tools, equipment, calibration or technical-information requirements

Task evidence

PPE, precautions and safe-system controls used

Safety-critical findings and immediate action

Work completed, actual findings, diagnosis, recommendations and verification

Knowledge check

1. Why must air suspension be controlled before work?

2. How can hub or steering wear affect tyre condition?

Knowledge check - continued

3. Explain how loading can alter steering or suspension symptoms.

4. When is alignment inappropriate until repair is completed?

5. What final checks are required after inspection or adjustment?

Assessor/Workplace Mentor observation

- [ ] Controls vehicle support, air suspension and crush zones.
- [ ] Inspects steering, suspension, axle and hub components.
- [ ] Measures and compares actual values with specifications.
- [ ] Links symptoms and tyre wear to likely root causes.
- [ ] Records repair and final-QA requirements.

Assessor/Workplace Mentor observation notes

Decision and feedback

Decision - select one

- [ ] PASS
- [ ] REFER

Evidence reference

Feedback and action required

Sign-off

Signatures confirm that this is the apprentice's own work and that the evidence and developmental decision are accurate.

Apprentice name

Assessor/Workplace Mentor name

Apprentice signature

Assessor/Workplace Mentor signature

Date

Heavy Vehicle Level 3

Task answer continuation | Form accessibility revision 12 November 2026

Use this page when an answer will not fit visibly in its original box.
Reference the question and write "See continuation page" in the original answer.
Keep each response within the visible space. Add another copy of this page if needed.

Apprentice name

Block / task / page number

Question / section reference

Continued answer

Question / section reference

Continued answer

Continuation evidence must be reviewed with the original task and referenced at sign-off.